

Collaboration Tools Standard

Version 4.0 | Owner: Digital Workplace | Effective 2026-03-15 | Next review 2027-03-15

1. Purpose

Which tools Zuqah Technologies uses for communication and file sharing, how to share with people outside Zuqah Technologies, and how long things are kept.

2. The approved set

Purpose	Tool	Notes
Email	Zuqah Technologies Mail	External, formal, and anything needing a record
Chat and meetings	Zuqah Technologies Teams	Internal day-to-day, and calls
Document storage	Zuqah Technologies Files	All working documents
Client-shared workspaces	Zuqah Technologies Files, external channel	See section 4
Internal knowledge	Zuqah Technologies Wiki	Documentation, runbooks, standards

Consumer messaging and file-sharing services must not be used for Zuqah Technologies or client information. This includes personal email, consumer cloud storage and personal messaging applications — the restriction is about where the data ends up, not about which company provides the tool.

3. Choosing between chat and email

A frequent question, and the guidance is simple:

- Chat for anything conversational, time-sensitive or internal.
- Email for anything a client will read, anything that needs a record, and

anything a person not currently in the conversation may later need to find.

Decisions reached in chat that matter should be summarised somewhere durable — the wiki, the engagement record, or an email. Chat is searchable but not discoverable by someone who does not know the conversation exists.

4. Sharing outside Zuqah Technologies

4.1 Guest access

External people can be invited to a specific Teams channel or Files folder. The invitation is granted per resource, never to the whole workspace, and requires:

- A business reason recorded on the invitation
- An expiry date, maximum 12 months
- Approval by the resource owner

Guests can see only what they are invited to. They cannot browse, search across Zuqah Technologies, or see the directory.

4.2 Sharing links

Link type	Available to	Use for
Specific people	Named recipients only	The default; use this
Anyone in Zuqah Technologies	All employees	Internal, non-sensitive
Anyone with the link	Anybody who has the URL	Off by default; requires approval

"Anyone with the link" is disabled by default and is enabled per request, with an expiry. It is worth understanding why: such a link is a credential, and a credential forwarded in an email chain is a credential outside your control.

4.3 Client data

Client information is governed first by the engagement's own agreement. Where the client's terms are stricter than this standard, the client's terms apply. Where they are silent, this standard applies.

Client data must remain in Zuqah Technologies Files or in the client's own systems. It must not be copied to personal storage, to a local folder synced to a personal account, or to a device that is not Zuqah Technologies-managed.

5. Meeting recording

Meetings may be recorded with the consent of participants. Consent must be explicit — announced at the start and given a chance to object — and, in some jurisdictions, is a legal requirement rather than a courtesy.

Recordings are retained for 90 days and then deleted automatically. A recording that needs to be kept longer should be saved to Zuqah Technologies Files with a stated reason.

Client meetings may be recorded only where the engagement permits it. When in doubt, ask before pressing record rather than after.

6. Retention

Content	Retained
Email	7 years
Teams chat	3 years
Teams channel messages	7 years
Meeting recordings	90 days
Files, active	Indefinitely
Files, deleted	93 days in the recycle bin, then permanently

Retention is applied automatically. Employees must not attempt to shorten it by deleting content that is subject to a legal hold; where a hold applies, People Operations or Legal will say so explicitly.

7. Naming and structure

Files belong in the engagement or practice folder, not in a personal folder. Content in a personal folder is invisible to colleagues and is deleted when the employee leaves — which is the most common way work is lost at Zuqah Technologies.

8. Leaving Zuqah Technologies

On departure, mailbox and files are retained per section 6 and transferred to the line manager. Personal content should be removed before the final working day. See the Code of Conduct on what may be treated as personal.

this document describes no real organisation's policy.*

Sample content for demonstration purposes. Zuqah Technologies is a fictional company and this document describes no real organisation's policy.